

Mid-term

HIST-103 | The Emergence of Modern Europe

Instructor: Dr. Lindsay O'Neill

Term: Fall 2026

Assignment Summary

Grade weight:	20%
Start date:	2025-08-25
Due date:	2025-10-06
Group project:	No
Notes:	In-class exam. Study guide lists Oct 8, 5-6:20pm; module lists Oct 6.

Overview

The midterm will include ten of the identification terms (I give a definition and you give the term, just like the quizzes) and one longer essay (you will be given five prompts in advance and two will be on the exam, you pick one to address). This will be an in-class exam.

Date & Location

- Midterm: October 8th, 5-6:20pm in class (per study guide)
- Oct 6: Midterm (per course schedule module)

Exam Format

- Part 1 (30%): Identifications - definitions of ten terms provided, you supply the term
- Part 2 (70%): Essay - TWO of five pre-released prompts appear on exam, answer ONE
- Terms will NOT be provided on the identification section
- By the midterm you will have gathered 33 identifications from class lectures

Essay Prompts (two will appear on exam)

- Could Europe in 1550 be called a 'new world'? Why or why not? [You can define what you mean by 'new world']
- Create a character for yourself who is on their deathbed between 1450 and 1550 and looking back on their life. What structured their life and what changes did they witness?
- True or False: 'The big events of the early modern period, like the Renaissance and westward expansion, were events created and experienced by male elites.' Defend your answer.
- What changed early modern Europe more: art and ideas, war, or disease and/or environmental change?

- Between 1348 and 1550 what impact did the outside world have upon Europe? Did it affect it more than interior changes?

Tips

- Incorporate knowledge from lectures and readings
- Use examples from readings - specific person, text, or event helps (evidence)
- Do not use information learned elsewhere - testing on what you learned from this class
- Essay should have an argument supported with examples, written in essay form

Full Syllabus Extract

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Hist 103: Midterm Study Guide Midterm: October 8th, 5-6:20pm in class Part 1 (30%): Identifications Part 2 (70%): Essay